



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Regina Coeli Academy

School Website: <https://reginacoeliacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Regina Coeli Academy (RCA) Pa 19001 presents a robust Catholic, classical framework centered on the liberal arts, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a liturgical, faith-informed approach to education. Public materials emphasize a Catholic formation, a time-tested classical curriculum, small class sizes, and an emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and community partnership with families. While RCA strongly signals classical foundations—particularly in its curriculum, theology, and pedagogy cues—the site does not overtly market a Great Books or explicit “Great Conversation” emphasis, which is a hallmark in some classical schools. This places RCA in the CLASSICAL category overall, with two clear areas that align more with a “SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL” characterization (Curriculum and Pedagogy emphasis that could more fully align with certain classical descriptors, notably the explicit Great Books/Great Conversation tradition and some high-level Socratic-seminar pedagogy that typically appears in higher-grade classical programs). See category-by-category notes below for evidence, keyword tallies, and the rationale for each rating.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- Core religious identity and liturgical life are clearly integrated into daily learning (Mass, liturgy, catechesis, Magisterial teaching, Scripture and Tradition).
- The curriculum centers on classical liberal arts and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit Catholic formation woven through the curriculum (Latin/Greek instruction noted; Great Books not explicitly listed).
- Pedagogy includes contemplative/restful elements and memory work (e.g., singing, recitation in lower grades; public speaking and rhetoric focus in some upper-level elements) with evidence of seminars and student forums in practice (Student Forum; public speaking expectations).
- Faculty are presented as hands-on mentors and the school emphasizes small class sizes and a living-curriculum approach; Parent and community partnership is highlighted (family formation, open campus, parent involvement).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Mass and liturgical life; explicit Catholic formation threaded into the curriculum; reference to Magisterial teaching, Scripture and Tradition; catechesis and liturgical life are embedded in daily schooling.
- Positive keyword analysis: Key terms such as Catholic, Mass, liturgy, theology/scripture, tradition, catechesis, Magisterial teaching appear in RCA materials (Catholic formation integrated throughout curriculum; Mass celebrated; catechesis; theology).
- Negative keyword indicators: None observed in materials reviewed for this category.
- Why this rating: Strong theological grounding and liturgical practice strongly align with transcendental and theological foundations typical of classical education’s religious-metaphysical strand.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Emphasis on formation rather than mere information; emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of humanity; clear alignment with the true, good, beautiful as real and knowable through a classical approach (e.g., “formation,” “virtue,” “wisdom,” “classical mission”).

- Positive keyword analysis: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical mission, liberal arts, telos (conceptual alignment with the classical telos); references to human flourishing and a life oriented toward truth, goodness, beauty.
- Negative keyword indicators: Workforce/workplace-formation signals are not emphasized; no explicit “21st-century skills” framing observed.
- Why this rating: RCA signals formation of character and human excellence, not primarily job-preparation, aligning with classical aims.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Curriculum frames itself as “the time-tested classical liberal arts course of study” and foregrounds the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit Liberal Arts, Latin/Greek instruction, and Western civilization/history framing; some Great Books/Great Conversation language is not explicit in public materials (the Great Books emphasis is a hallmark in many classical schools).
- Positive keyword analysis: liberal arts, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Greek, Western civilization, history-focused framing (within curriculum outlines) appear in RCA materials.
- Negative keyword indicators: Absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in accessible materials (a classic signal of a stricter “Great Books” orientation), though the Trivium-and-liberal-arts framework is present.
- Why this rating: The school embraces classical curriculum elements (Trivium; liberal arts; languages; history framing) but does not clearly foreground Great Books or the “Great Conversation” in publicly accessible materials, which nudges the category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Lower grades show contemplative/restful pedagogy with singing and memory work; Montessori influences in early grades; upper grades include rhetoric-oriented aims and public speaking; Student Forum and opportunities for rhetoric and oratory are discussed in alumni materials; the school emphasizes memory, recitation, and catechesis as part of pedagogy; Paideia/seminar seminar impulses appear in practice and alumni accounts, though not as a formal umbrella program in the site’s core descriptions.
- Positive keyword analysis: chanting, recitation, memory work, scholé/restful learning, seminar/colloquy, rhetoric, public speaking, catechesis, liturgical calendar integration.
- Negative keyword indicators: Explicit “experiential learning focus” or “project-based learning dominance” signals are not prominently described; however, the public-facing materials do not fully foreground a full spectrum of rigorous Socratic seminars in the upper grades (which often appear in high-school-grade classical programs). This aligns with a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than full CLASSICAL in pedagogy.
- Why this rating: RCA demonstrates a blend of contemplative/restful elements and rhetoric/public-speaking emphasis, but its explicit, high-school-style Socratic/Seminar pedagogy and full-scale Great Books-style seminar culture are not clearly foregrounded in the accessible materials, placing it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Emphasis on dedicated, virtuous teachers; small class sizes; faculty as the living curriculum and core of the school; a portrait of teachers and a strong faculty culture are described; the school emphasizes mentor-like teachers and a collegial, “living curriculum” approach.
- Positive keyword analysis: master/mentor figures, living curriculum, portrait of teachers, collegial culture, small classes, dedicated faculty, character formation.

- Negative keyword indicators: No strong negative signals about faculty context; the materials frame faculty positively as exemplars of virtue and knowledge.
- Why this rating: The school presents a robust faculty culture with small classes and a living curriculum, matching classical expectations for teacher as mentor and exemplar.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school highlights partnership with parents, parental formation opportunities (e.g., book studies, gatherings), open campus visitation, and multiple family-oriented/faith-life activities; Parent-Student Handbook materials and family-centered theology and catechesis are part of the ecosystem; RCA explicitly invites parental involvement and viewing parents as co-teachers in a Catholic-classical formation environment.
- Positive keyword analysis: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus, family liturgy, catechesis at home, community feasts and liturgical events.
- Negative keyword indicators: No negative signals about parent involvement; the materials emphasize proactive parental engagement rather than a consumer-facing model.
- Why this rating: RCA presents strong parental involvement and community formation signals, aligning with classical expectations for an engaged parent-community partnership.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL - The aggregate signals across six categories indicate a consistent alignment with classical education principles: a faith-centered, Trivium-informed curriculum; a liturgical and communal Catholic life; a living-teacher/mentoring faculty; and an active partnership with families and the broader community. The primary reason the Curriculum and Pedagogy categories are marked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is the relatively limited explicit emphasis on Great Books and entirely Socratic/Hogarth-style seminar pedagogy in the publicly available materials—elements many other classical schools foreground strongly. The presence of Trivium, liberal arts framing, liturgical integration, small-class culture, and a robust Catholic formation and family-partner model, however, makes RCA Classically aligned overall.

What Would Move the Needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Add explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and corresponding content to the Curriculum and reading lists, and highlight a plan for integrating Great Books into the Grades 6–8 sequence to align with a stricter Great Books-based classical model.

- Expand visible, scalable Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades (even if not a full high-school program) to echo classical seminar culture, with clear rubrics, exemplar prompts, and student-led discourse.
- Strengthen history-as-history across the curriculum with explicit chronological framing and primary-source study that aligns with classical history pedagogy; emphasize Western Civilization as a through-line across grades.
- Deepen explicit formation in Great Books discussions, memory work, and recitation in more grade bands, including structured opportunities for students to present argumentative and rhetorical pieces.
- Heighten explicit parental formation content on the website (e.g., structured book studies and parent seminars) to reinforce the co-teaching partnership with families and to broaden participation in classical formation outside the classroom.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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